

a bit of a guilt kick-back. When you start showing yourself some kindness and understanding, you might start to worry or feel guilty that you're giving yourself an easy ride, or letting yourself off too lightly. You might be concerned that letting go of the guilt and shame that you feel about the financial mistakes you've made will leave you open to making them again, but you need to trust me when I say that this isn't the case.

Of course, if your immediate response to any mistake is to shrug it off without a second thought, without even a moment of reflection, you will probably make it over and over again. You will continue doing the same thing, expecting different results – the very definition of insanity according to someone who almost certainly was not Albert Einstein (but he usually gets the credit in memes). Whoever said it, it makes sense. However, ignoring your mistakes is not the only way that this happens – it often occurs as the result of overanalysing and punishing yourself for your mistakes, or because you're waiting for some big moment of reckoning to set you on the right path. We need to find the sweet spot: accountability without unnecessary punishment. We need to acknowledge those mistakes in order to learn from them and move on, but overanalysing and dwelling on them will keep us locked in the same behaviours and deny us the space we need to grow.